

VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN)

DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY → THREE CONTESTED ZONES → FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER → VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE → WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN → AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY

DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY

C. 1336

CONVENTIONAL VIJAYANAGARA FOUNDATION ANCHOR

BAHMANI KINGDOM ESTABLISHED UNDER ALAUDDIN HASAN BAHMAN SHAH

DEVA RAYA II STRENGTHENS VIJAYANAGARA MILITARY ADAPTATION

BAHMANI CAPITAL SHIFTS FROM GULBARGA TO BIDAR

KRISHNADEVA RAYA AND TULUVA APOGEE

TALIKOTA DESTROYS THE CAPITAL FABRIC; ARAVIDU POWER CONTINUES.

c. 1336 → conventional Vijayanagara foundation anchor

1347 → Bahmani kingdom established under Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah

1420s-40s → Deva Raya II strengthens Vijayanagara military adaptation

1425 → Bahmani capital shifts from Gulbarga to Bidar

1509-29 → Krishnadeva Raya and Tuluva apogee

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- c. 1336 → conventional Vijayanagara foundation anchor
- 1347 → Bahmani kingdom established under Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1420s-40s → Deva Raya II strengthens Vijayanagara military adaptation
- 1425 → Bahmani capital shifts from Gulbarga to Bidar

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1509-29 → Krishnadeva Raya and Tuluva apogee
- 1565 → Talikota destroys the capital fabric; Aravidu power continues.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1565 → Talikota destroys the capital fabric; Aravidu power continues.

01

STAGE 01 THREE CONTESTED ZONES

THREE CONTESTED ZONES

TUNGABHADRA DOAB

FERTILE FRONTIER, FORTS AND RECURRING CAMPAIGNS

AGRARIAN BASIN, ROUTES AND EASTERN-COAST CONNECTIONS

PORTS, CUSTOMS, HORSE IMPORTS AND WESTERN MARITIME ACCESS

REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS + PRESTIGE

POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY EXPLAINS MORE THAN A HINDU-MUSLIM BINARY.

TUNGABHADRA DOAB → fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns

KRISHNA-GODAVARI → agrarian basin, routes and eastern-coast connections

KONKAN-GOA → ports, customs, horse imports and western maritime access

REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS + PRESTIGE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- TUNGABHADRA DOAB → fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns
- KRISHNA-GODAVARI → agrarian basin, routes and eastern-coast connections

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- KONKAN-GOA → ports, customs, horse imports and western maritime access
- REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS + PRESTIGE

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULE: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.
- TUNGABHADRA DOAB → fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.

02

STAGE 02 FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER

FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER

RULERS, GRANTS AND DATED CLAIMS

SELECTIVE FORMULAE

SETTLEMENT, WATER AND BUILDINGS

CANNOT RECOVER EVERY MOTIVE

OBSERVED CITY AND COURT

PERSPECTIVE, GENRE AND EXAGGERATION

LATER TRADITIONS

INSCRIPTIONS → rulers, grants and dated claims

ARCHAEOLOGY → settlement, water and buildings

TRAVELLERS → observed city and court

LATER TRADITIONS → remembered origins

selective formulae

cannot recover every motive

perspective, genre and exaggeration

chronology and political use require care

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- INSCRIPTIONS → rulers, grants and dated claims
- selective formulae
- ARCHAEOLOGY → settlement, water and buildings

METHOD / DEBATE

- cannot recover every motive
- TRAVELLERS → observed city and court
- perspective, genre and exaggeration

HISTORICAL RESULT

- LATER TRADITIONS → remembered origins
- chronology and political use require care
- SAFE OPENING → c. 1336 is conventional; founder biographies remain debated.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE OPENING → c. 1336 is conventional; founder biographies remain debated.

03

LATER TRADITIONS → remembered origins

CHRONOLOGY AND POLITICAL USE REQUIRE CARE

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- INSCRIPTIONS → rulers, grants and dated claims
- selective formulae
- ARCHAEOLOGY → settlement, water and buildings

METHOD / DEBATE

- cannot recover every motive
- TRAVELLERS → observed city and court
- perspective, genre and exaggeration

HISTORICAL RESULT

- LATER TRADITIONS → remembered origins
- chronology and political use require care
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE OPENING → c. 1336 is conventional; founder biographies remain debated.

03

STAGE 03

VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE

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EARLY CONSOLIDATION AND DECCAN RIVALRY

MILITARY INTERVENTION AMID SUCCESSION PRESSURE

KRISHNADEVA RAYA, CAMPAIGNS AND CULTURAL PATRONAGE

CONTINUATION AFTER THE 1565 CAPITAL CATASTROPHE

DYNASTIC REPLACEMENT DID NOT AUTOMATICALLY ERASE THE STATE.

SANGAMA → early consolidation and Deccan rivalry

SALUVA → military intervention amid succession pressure

TULUVA → Krishnadeva Raya, campaigns and cultural patronage

ARAVIDU → continuation after the 1565 capital catastrophe

LESSON: dynastic replacement did not automatically erase the state.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- SANGAMA → early consolidation and Deccan rivalry
- SALUVA → military intervention amid succession pressure

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- TULUVA → Krishnadeva Raya, campaigns and cultural patronage
- ARAVIDU → continuation after the 1565 capital catastrophe

IMPACT / LIMIT

- LESSON: dynastic replacement did not automatically erase the state.
- SANGAMA → early consolidation and Deccan rivalry

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON: dynastic replacement did not automatically erase the state.

04

STAGE 04

WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN CAPACITY

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TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS CULTIVATION + URBAN

STATE CAPACITY, BUT BENEFITS AND CONTROL REMAINED SOCIALLY UNEQUAL

UNESCO BRIDGE

HYDRAULIC REMAINS SUPPORT INTEGRATION, NOT A WELFARE CENSUS.

TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual

water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience

STATE CAPACITY, but benefits and control remained socially unequal

UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual
- water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- STATE CAPACITY, but benefits and control remained socially unequal
- UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual
- water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

05

STAGE 05

AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN

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RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM

TERRITORIAL COMMAND

NAYAKA MAINTAINS TROOPS, REMITS OBLIGATIONS AND GOVERNS LOCALLY SERVICE

HEREDITARY DRIFT, BARGAINING AND LATER NAYAKA POLITIES

COMPARISON WITH IQTA IS FUNCTIONAL, NOT AN EQUATION.

RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND

NAYAKA maintains troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also

entrenches regional power weak centre → hereditary drift, bargaining and later nayaka polities

CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND
- NAYAKA maintains troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- entrenches regional power weak centre → hereditary drift, bargaining and later nayaka polities
- CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

06

STAGE 06

HORSE-PORT-MILITARY CHAIN

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WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY

KONKAN ROUTES

INLAND MOVEMENT AND PAYMENT CAVALRY RECRUITMENT + ARCHERY +

IMPORTED HORSES MATTERED, BUT DID NOT ALONE DECIDE WARS.

GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES → inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment +

archery + commanders + fodder and remounts competitive adaptation by Vijayanagara and Deccan states

RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY → PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS
- GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES → inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment +

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- archery + commanders + fodder and remounts competitive adaptation by Vijayanagara and Deccan states
- RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY → PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS
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VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN) • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2673-5907 of 11252 • continues below

06

STAGE 06 HORSE-PORT-MILITARY CHAIN

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DEBATE / LEGACY

- WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY → PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS
- GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES → inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment +

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

07

STAGE 07 HAMPI URBAN SYSTEM

HAMPI URBAN SYSTEM

RIVER, BOULDERS, PLAINS AND DEFENDED APPROACHES

TEMPLES, PROCESSIONS, TANKS AND CONTINUING RITUAL

ENCLOSURES, AUDIENCE SPACES, STABLES AND ELITE DISPLAY

BAZAARS, CRAFT PRODUCTION AND SUBURBAN SETTLEMENTS

CHANNELS, WELLS, TANKS AND AGRICULTURAL SUPPORT

CAPITAL, MARKET, RITUAL AND ECOLOGY FORMED ONE SYSTEM.

LANDSCAPE → river, boulders, plains and defended approaches

SACRED → temples, processions, tanks and continuing ritual

ROYAL → enclosures, audience spaces, stables and elite display

COMMERCIAL → bazaars, craft production and suburban settlements

HYDRAULIC → channels, wells, tanks and agricultural support

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LANDSCAPE → river, boulders, plains and defended approaches
- SACRED → temples, processions, tanks and continuing ritual

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- ROYAL → enclosures, audience spaces, stables and elite display
- COMMERCIAL → bazaars, craft production and suburban settlements

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HYDRAULIC → channels, wells, tanks and agricultural support
- VERDICT: capital, market, ritual and ecology formed one system.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: capital, market, ritual and ecology formed one system.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: capital, market, ritual and ecology formed one system.

08

STAGE 08 BAHMANI STATE AND CAPITAL SHIFT

BAHMANI STATE AND CAPITAL SHIFT

1347 GULBARGA

FOUNDATION, FRONTIER COMMAND AND EARLY CONSOLIDATION

1425 BIDAR

REVISED STRATEGIC CENTRE AND COURTLY-CULTURAL INVESTMENT

PROVINCIAL COMMAND, REVENUE AND MILITARY RESOURCES LATE 15TH C.

STRONGER FACTIONS AND SUCCESSOR-STATE FORMATION

CAPITAL SHIFT IS NOT THE SAME EVENT AS DYNASTIC

1347 GULBARGA → foundation, frontier command and early consolidation

1425 BIDAR → revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment

TARAFS → provincial command, revenue and military resources late 15th c. → stronger factions and

TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1347 GULBARGA → foundation, frontier command and early consolidation
- 1425 BIDAR → revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- TARAFS → provincial command, revenue and military resources late 15th c. → stronger factions and successor-state formation
- TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1347 GULBARGA → foundation, frontier command and early consolidation
- 1425 BIDAR → revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment

MECHANISM / VERDICT — TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

09

STAGE 09 MAHMUD GAWAN REFORM LOGIC

MAHMUD GAWAN REFORM LOGIC

LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY MORE

FACTIONAL RESISTANCE

GAWAN'S EXECUTION

SOUND DESIGN CAN FAIL WITHOUT A DURABLE GOVERNING COALITION.

LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control

enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's

LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control + khalisa
- enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.
- LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control + khalisa

DEBATE / LEGACY

- enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's execution
- LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.

09

STAGE 09

MAHMUD GAWAN REFORM LOGIC

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FACTIONAL RESISTANCE

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.
- LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control + khalisa

DEBATE / LEGACY

- enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's execution
- LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.

10

STAGE 10

DECCANI-AFAQI COALITION PROBLEM

DECCANI-AFAQI COALITION PROBLEM

LONGER-SETTLED REGIONAL MUSLIM ELITES AND ALLIES

NEWER WESTERN AND CENTRAL ASIAN MIGRANTS AND NETWORKS

OFFICE, PATRONAGE, MILITARY COMMAND AND COURT ACCESS

CROSS-CUTTING TIES

MARRIAGE, LANGUAGE, SERVICE AND LOCAL ALLIANCE

FACTIONAL LABELS STRUCTURE POLITICS BUT ARE NOT RACIAL ABSOLUTES

DO NOT TURN ELITE RIVALRY INTO A TIMELESS COMMUNAL

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

DECCANIS → longer-settled regional Muslim elites and allies

AFAQIS → newer western and Central Asian migrants and networks

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

COMPETITION → office, patronage, military command and court access

CROSS-CUTTING TIES → marriage, language, service and local alliance

DEBATE / LEGACY

OUTCOME → factional labels structure politics but are not racial absolutes

TRAP: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DECCANIS → longer-settled regional Muslim elites and allies
- AFAQIS → newer western and Central Asian migrants and networks

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COMPETITION → office, patronage, military command and court access
- CROSS-CUTTING TIES → marriage, language, service and local alliance

DEBATE / LEGACY

- OUTCOME → factional labels structure politics but are not racial absolutes
- TRAP: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 09 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 09 ANSWER SPINE

CONNECTED DECCAN FIELD ORGANISED BY RESOURCES AND ROUTES

WATER + CAPITAL + AMARAM + CAVALRY + MARITIME

CAPITALS + TARAFS + GAWAN REFORM + FACTIONAL COALITION

INSCRIPTIONS + ARCHAEOLOGY + TRAVELLERS + MONUMENTS

TURNING POINT

1565 DESTROYS HAMPI FABRIC, NOT EVERY POLITICAL NETWORK

RIVALRY AND EXCHANGE JOINTLY SHAPED LATER DECCAN FORMATIONS.

OPEN → connected Deccan field organised by resources and routes

VIJAYANAGARA → water + capital + amaram + cavalry + maritime diplomacy

BAHMANI → capitals + tarafs + Gawan reform + factional coalition

EVIDENCE → inscriptions + archaeology + travellers + monuments

TURNING POINT → 1565 destroys Hampi fabric, not every political network

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OPEN → connected Deccan field organised by resources and routes
- VIJAYANAGARA → water + capital + amaram + cavalry + maritime diplomacy

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- BAHMANI → capitals + tarafs + Gawan reform + factional coalition
- EVIDENCE → inscriptions + archaeology + travellers + monuments

DEBATE / LEGACY

- TURNING POINT → 1565 destroys Hampi fabric, not every political network
- CLOSE → rivalry and exchange jointly shaped later Deccan formations.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → rivalry and exchange jointly shaped later Deccan formations.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN) — ADVANCED

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Vijayanagara & the Bahmani Kingdom (Deccan) — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept: Horses and state power
- Deva Raya II's army reform was a response to Bahmani superiority in horses and mounted archers.
- The 1367 conflict is important not merely for violence but for the treaty

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN) • TILE 4/4 • same master rows 8018-11252 of 11252 • end